

Chapter 65-1

Liang Shi's right hand caressed the silver bracelet on her left wrist. The patterns on it were intricate, and she could feel the texture with her fingernails.

It was clearly a piece of silver jewelry that should seem out of place in this era, yet it still looked elegant and beautiful.

Even colleagues in the office had once complimented her on this bracelet, saying it was more delicate than many silver pieces made nowadays.

It was indeed an exquisite antique craft piece.

Silver jewelry becomes brighter the more you wear it, and clearer the more you polish it.

This bracelet on Liang Shi's wrist was much brighter than before.

Although she and the woman were now facing each other directly, the woman still didn't remove her sunglasses and only nodded slightly toward her.

Yet Liang Shi subconsciously covered the silver bracelet on her wrist.

After a while, Su Yu, accompanied by the woman, came over to greet Rainbow. "Zhou Caihong, have you finished your handicraft homework?"

Rainbow furrowed her brows slightly. "School just ended..."

"I finished mine already." Su Yu said, "My mom drew the template for me, and I quickly cut it out."

"Oh." Rainbow praised without any emotion, "Your mom is really amazing."

Su Yu: "...?"

Not receiving the praise she had anticipated, her little face fell, and she huffed lightly. "You're really no fun."

As soon as she finished speaking, the woman lightly patted her shoulder. "A-Yu, you can't be rude."

"Mmm~" Su Yu whimpered aggrievedly.

The woman then apologized to Rainbow on Su Yu's behalf. "I'm sorry, little Caihong. Su Yu speaks without thinking."

"It's okay, Auntie." Rainbow smiled obediently, but her words were particularly cutting. "She's like this at kindergarten too."

The woman's expression changed slightly, her tone becoming somewhat awkward. "Then I'm really sorry."

"It's fine. Kids, you know, they all love to show off." Rainbow said with an air of composed wisdom.¹

Liang Shi sat to the side listening, helplessly covering her forehead. If she were to have a daughter like Rainbow in the future, she really wouldn't know how to raise her. Currently, it seemed Zhou Li's approach was the most straightforward and effective—just let her develop freely and do whatever she likes.

Hearing this, the woman didn't show the mocking or disdainful look that ordinary adults would have. Instead, she became interested and asked her gently, "What about you? Don't you like to show off?"

Rainbow was silent for two seconds. "Occasionally."

Liang Shi: "..."

This child Rainbow had a very big advantage—she faced her inner self honestly.

It was probably the childlike nature still preserved in her bones; no matter how high her IQ, it would never completely disappear.

And she could achieve a level of honesty that eighty percent of adults couldn't.

"Mom, look." Before the woman could say anything more, Su Yu couldn't wait to tattle. "She's always like this."

As Su Yu spoke, she began to imitate, mimicking Rainbow's tone: "It's fine, whatever's fine, okay, thank you, no need, I don't like it."

Liang Shi listened from the side and couldn't help but glance over at Rainbow.

She saw Rainbow frowning, lips pressed together, looking deeply resentful, as if she was contemplating whether or not to interrupt this "parroting" act in front of the other person's mother.

Fortunately, before Rainbow's patience ran out, Su Yu stopped.

Su Yu also had a little-adult demeanor, crossing her arms and looking at Rainbow. "Zhou Caihong, are you very angry?"

The paper cup in Rainbow's hand was nearly crushed, but she glanced at the woman beside Su Yu and practically ground out through her teeth, "No."

"See." Su Yu said again, "She's like this every day. Being deskmates with her is really..."

Su Yu looked up at the sky. "So bori—"

Before she could finish saying "boring," her forehead was smacked by the woman.

Su Yu immediately looked stunned, blinking her eyes. That delicate face like carved jade—one that would make anyone feel three parts of tender affection upon seeing it—instantly fell, looking extremely aggrieved. "Mom!"

"What?" The woman stood there, hands stuffed into her coat pockets, as if to prevent any attempts at acting cute. She looked sternly at Su Yu. "Apologize to your deskmate."

Su Yu pouted. "I won't."

"If you apologize to your deskmate, I'll apologize to you," the woman said.

Su Yu hesitated and began to think it over.

"It's not necessary, Auntie." Rainbow spoke up first. "She's always like this. I'm used to it."

The woman's face was full of embarrassment.

After a long while, she sighed helplessly. "I often hear Su Yu mention you. She says you're very smart. Now that I've met you, you're indeed extraordinary."

After saying this, she paused. "I'm sorry, you're acting so mature that I can't help but speak formally to you. I was just complimenting you..."

"It's okay, I understand." Rainbow took a sip of cola and waited until she swallowed before saying, "You're complimenting me for being unusual."

Rainbow had received too many compliments since she was little.

This bit from the woman was merely a drop in the bucket² for her.

After a brief moment of surprise, the woman finally couldn't help but turn her gaze to the only adult at the table.

Looking at Liang Shi, she couldn't help but exclaim, "You've raised your daughter really well."

Liang Shi, who had been sitting there eating melon and watching the show³: "?"

Liang Shi looked confused, then finally reacted. She and Rainbow denied it almost in unison.

"I'm not her mother."

"She's not my mother."

After speaking, the two made eye contact. Rainbow shrugged helplessly, then lowered her head to continue eating.

"Huh?" It was the woman who was left stunned instead.

Footnotes:

¹ "老神在在" (lǎo shén zài zài) - A Chinese expression describing someone who appears calm, composed, and unperturbed, often with an air of knowing wisdom beyond their years. Here it emphasizes how Rainbow speaks with a maturity unusual for her age.

² "九牛一毛" (jiǔ niú yī máo) - Literally "a single hair from nine oxen," this is a Chinese idiom meaning something extremely insignificant or a tiny fraction of the whole.

³ "吃瓜看戲" (chī guā kàn xì) - Literally "eating melon and watching a show," this is Chinese internet slang for being a bystander/spectator watching drama unfold, similar to "watching from the sidelines" or being a casual observer of entertaining events. The "eating melon" part comes from the image of someone munching on watermelon seeds while watching something interesting happen.